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AI



GitHub Copilot crosses 20M all-time users

GitHub Copilot, an AI coding tool offered by Microsoft-owned GitHub, has now reached more than 20 million users, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella said on the company's [earnings call](#) Wednesday. A GitHub spokesperson confirmed to TechCrunch that this number represents "all-time users."

That means 5 million people have tried out GitHub Copilot for the first time in the last three months — the company reported in April [the tool had reached 15 million users](#). Microsoft and GitHub don't report how many of these 20 million people have continued to use the AI coding tool on a monthly or daily basis — though those metrics are likely far lower.

IMAGE CREDITS:
LIONEL NG/BLOOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

Microsoft also reported that GitHub Copilot, which is among the most popular AI coding tools offered today, is used by 90% of the Fortune 100. The product's growth among enterprise customers has also grown about 75% compared to last quarter, according to the company.

AI coding tools are rising in popularity, and they seem to be one of the few AI products generating notable revenue. In 2024, Nadella said [GitHub Copilot was a larger business](#) than all of GitHub was when Microsoft acquired it in 2018. In the year since, it seems GitHub Copilot's growth rate has continued in a positive direction.

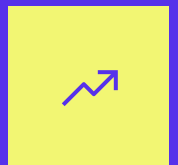
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The world's most popular AI coding tools still have tiny user bases compared to AI chatbots like ChatGPT and Gemini, which attract hundreds of millions of users every month. Of course, software engineering is more niche than the general informational queries offered by AI chatbots.

That said, software engineers and their employers seem to be willing to pay a premium for AI coding tools. And with Microsoft's long list of enterprise customers and GitHub's ecosystem of developers, GitHub Copilot is well positioned to dominate the market for enterprise AI coding tools.

Cursor, another popular AI coding tool, wants to challenge GitHub Copilot in the enterprise, and it's been [scooping up talent](#) from fledgling AI startups to do so. Cursor reportedly had [more than a million people](#) using its product every day in March, according to Bloomberg. At that time, the company generated about \$200 million in annualized recurring revenue. Today, [Cursor's ARR is more than \\$500 million](#), suggesting there are now a lot more people using its products every day.

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While GitHub Copilot and Cursor initially sought to tackle different parts of the developer experience, they're steadily converging into similar products.

Both companies have recently introduced [AI agents to review code](#) and [catch bugs](#) introduced by humans. GitHub and Cursor are also trying to create [AI agents that automate programmer workflows](#), allowing developers to offload tasks altogether. Nadella said during Wednesday's earnings call that GitHub was seeing great momentum with their AI coding agents.

Beyond Cursor, GitHub has an array of well-capitalized competitors that would like to sell AI coding tools to the enterprise.

There's Google — which [acquired the leaders of AI coding startup Windsurf](#) — as well as Cognition, the maker of Devin that [subsequently acquired the rest of Windsurf's team](#). And there's OpenAI and Anthropic, which are both building out their own AI coding offerings powered by in-house AI models, Codex and Claude Code, respectively, in an attempt to win the market.

The nascent space is quickly heating up into one of AI's most competitive markets.

Topics: [AI](#) [ai coding](#) [GitHub Copilot](#) [Microsoft](#)



Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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Copilot

IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

AI



Microsoft Copilot: Everything you need to know about Microsoft's AI

Kyle Wiggers — 8:49 AM PST · February 7, 2025

Copilot is Microsoft's take on productivity-boosting generative AI, and it continues to grow and expand with Microsoft's AI ambitions. Today, there are around a dozen Copilot-branded products powering various capabilities in Microsoft software and services, like summarizations in Microsoft Outlook and transcriptions in Microsoft Teams.

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That's in addition to Microsoft-owned GitHub's Copilot tool for generating code, and the Copilot that lives on [Windows](#) and the web, which serves as a general-purpose assistant.

In this post, we explain the many Microsoft Copilots available and what they do, and the differences between the premium and free editions.

What is Microsoft Copilot?

Microsoft Copilot, [previously known as Bing Chat](#), is built into Microsoft's search engine, Bing, as well as Windows 10, Windows 11, and the Microsoft Edge [sidebar](#). (Newer PCs even have a [dedicated keyboard key](#) for launching Copilot.) There's also [stand-alone Copilot apps for Android and iOS](#) and an [in-app Telegram room](#).

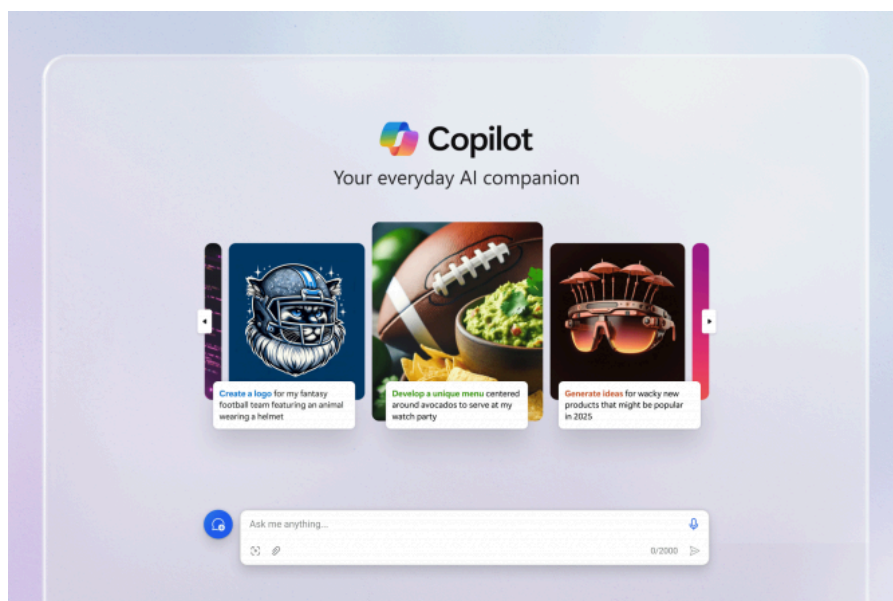


IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

Powered by fine-tuned versions of OpenAI's models (OpenAI and Microsoft have a [close working relationship](#)), Copilot can perform a range of tasks described in natural language, like writing poems and essays, as well as translating text into other languages and summarizing sources from around the web (albeit [imperfectly](#)).

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Copilot, like OpenAI's [ChatGPT](#) and Google's [Gemini](#), can browse the web (in Copilot's case, via Bing) for up-to-date information. It sometimes [gets things wrong](#), but for timely queries, access to search results *can* give Copilot an advantage over offline bots [such as Anthropic's Claude](#).

Copilot can create images by tapping [Image Creator](#), Microsoft's image generator [built on OpenAI's DALL-E 3 model](#). And it can [generate songs via an integration with Suno](#), the AI music-generating platform. Typing something like "Create an image of a zebra" or "Generate a song with a jazz rhythm" in Copilot will pull in the relevant tool.

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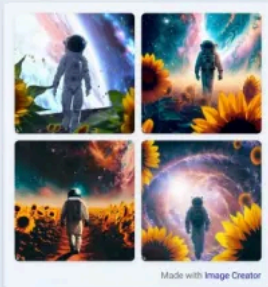
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Can you create me an image of an astronaut walking through a galaxy of sunflowers?

Sure, I'll use Image Creator to draw that for you.



? Change the astronaut to a cat Change the sunflowers to roses Add a moon in the background



Type message



IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

On the subject of integrations, Copilot [supports plug-ins](#) for third-party apps and websites. There's plug-ins for Instacart (for meal planning and cooking-related questions), Kayak (for trip planning), OpenTable (for restaurant reservations) and Shopify, to name a few examples. More are being added on a regular basis.

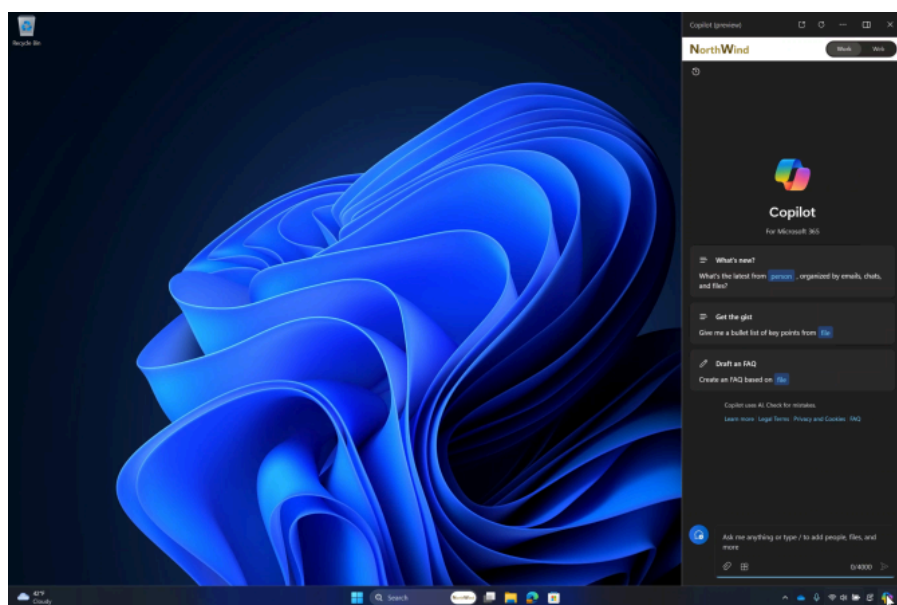
Copilot also drives **Copilot Pages**, an embeddable digital canvas where users can edit and share Copilot-originated content. Paying customers (more on that below) get access to **BizChat**, a business-focused hub that ties into Pages to pull data from the web (and work files) to help create things like project plans, meeting notes, proposals, and more.



Which Windows settings can Copilot control?

On Windows 11 ([but not necessarily Windows 10](#)), Copilot can [control certain settings and functions](#), acting as a digital concierge of sorts.

With Copilot, either by typing or using Windows 11's speech recognition functionality, users can perform actions on a PC like turning the battery saver on or off, showing device and system information, launching live captions, displaying the PC's IP address, and emptying the recycle bin.



COPILOT IN WINDOWS.

IMAGE CREDITS:MICROSOFT

A [toggle in the Copilot experience on Windows 11](#) switches between “Work” and “Web” mode, with the former bringing Copilot’s Microsoft 365 capabilities in the Windows interface.

What is Copilot Pro?

[Copilot Pro is Microsoft’s premium Copilot product](#), priced at \$20 per month.

Copilot Pro customers get priority access to the most capable OpenAI models (e.g., [o1](#)) during peak times. And select features of Copilot can only be accessed with a Pro subscription, such as higher-resolution images from Image Creator.

Copilot Pro also gives users access to generative AI functions across the Microsoft 365 suite of productivity apps: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, and OneNote.

In Word and OneNote, Copilot can write, edit, summarize, and generate text. Copilot in Excel and PowerPoint can turn natural language prompts into presentations and visualizations (optionally grounded in data from files and templates). And in Outlook, Copilot can help draft email responses with toggles for adjusting the length or tone.

More features as part of Microsoft's Copilot **Wave 2 update** are coming down the pipeline.

Copilot in PowerPoint will soon pull in company-approved images from a SharePoint library, while Outlook will get a "Prioritize my inbox" capability that summarizes each email (and gives insights like who you've been most responsive too). In late 2024, Outlook users will also gain the ability to "teach" Copilot topics, keywords, and people of interest so that those emails are always marked as high-priority.



In Excel, Copilot can format data, create graphs, generate pivot tables and guide users through creating new formulas and macros. It can also make use of the programming language Python for advanced data analysis – in natural language, users can describe forecasting, risk analysis, and

data visualization tasks and Copilot will translate the text to the necessary Python code to perform these tasks.



A future version of Copilot in Word will let you quickly pull in data from outside Word, PowerPoint, and PDF documents as well as emails, encrypted docs, and meetings. Elsewhere, in OneDrive, Copilot will summarize, show metrics about, and compare the differences between files for you.

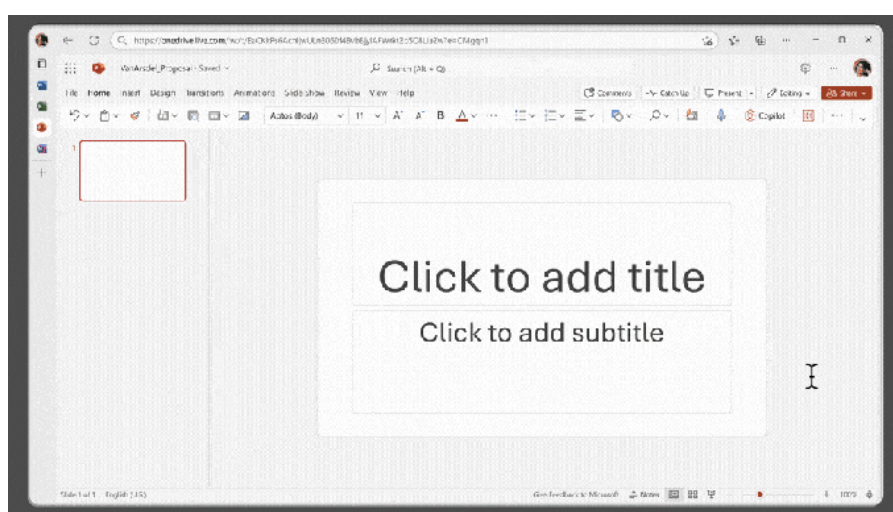


IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

Beyond the Microsoft 365 upgrades, Copilot Pro subscribers get landscape formatting options and 100 “boosts” per day in Image Creator (versus only 15 per day for free users) to speed up the image-generation process.

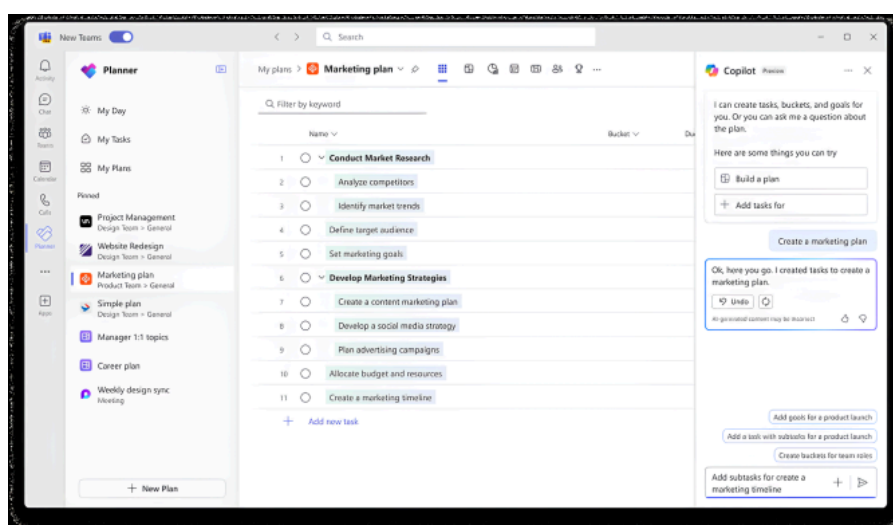
Importantly, Copilot Pro *does not* come with Copilot in Teams, a Copilot feature in Microsoft Teams that provides real-time summaries and action items

while handling tasks like identifying people for follow-ups. Copilot in Teams is exclusive to enterprise Copilot customers, meaning those with an enterprise-class (or equivalent) Microsoft 365 license.

What is Microsoft 365 Copilot?

Separate and distinct from the consumer Copilot SKU is Microsoft 365 Copilot, a collection of generative AI add-ons to Microsoft 365 with an emphasis on business apps.

Microsoft 365 Copilot is priced at \$30 per user per month and available to customers with a Microsoft 365 E3, E5, Business Standard, or Business Premium license. It delivers many of the same capabilities across the Microsoft 365 family of apps as Copilot Pro, but with the addition of “enterprise-grade data protection” and the Semantic Index, a back-end system that creates a map of the data and content in an organization to allow Copilot to deliver more personalized responses.



TEAM COPILOT IN PLANNER.

IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

Microsoft recently launched [Microsoft 365 Chat](#), for example, a tool that pulls info from content across Microsoft 365 apps (e.g., Word docs, PowerPoint presentations) to answer questions.

There are many, many Copilots besides. Here's a partial list of them and their "skills":

- [Copilot in Power Pages](#) can generate text, forms, chatbots, and web page layouts, and can create and edit image and site design themes.
- [Copilot for Sales](#) can help write email responses to customers or perform sales-related tasks such as sending summaries of Teams meetings through Outlook.
- **Copilot in Microsoft Supply Chain Center** can proactively flag issues like weather, financials, and geography that might impact supply chain processes.
- **Copilot for Service** can draft answers to customer queries via chat or email and provide a chat experience for customer service agents that draws from knowledge bases as well as case history.
- [Copilot for Azure](#) can suggest configurations for Microsoft Azure-hosted apps and environments and help with troubleshooting by identifying potential issues and solutions.
- [Copilot for Security](#) aims to summarize and "make sense" of different forms of cyberthreat intelligence.
- **Copilot in Fabric** helps explore, prepare, and visualize data.
- **Copilot in Intune** helps manage security policies and settings and troubleshoot device issues.
- [Team Copilot](#) can help manage meeting agendas in Teams and extend to Loop and Planner to create and assign tasks, track deadlines, and notify team members when their input is needed.

Note that some of Microsoft’s Copilots, like [Copilot in Business Central](#), are included in the base software licenses and don’t require paying an additional fee. Others, like Copilot for Sales and Copilot for Service, cost an extra \$20 per user per month or \$50 per user per month without an active Microsoft 365 Copilot subscription.

Copilot Studio

[Copilot Studio](#) is a dashboard that lets customers give Microsoft 365 Copilot access to data in their, or a third party’s, customer relationship management software, enterprise resource management systems, and other databases and repositories using prebuilt connectors or connectors they build themselves. Through Copilot Studio, customers can build guardrails for Copilots and create and publish their own custom-tailored “copilots.”

Microsoft 365 Copilot subscribers can tap Copilot Studio to create their own custom copilot by describing it in natural language. Copilots can filter to specific datasets for particular teams or users, or connect to an automation, plug-in, or third-party service to kick off actions or a workflow.

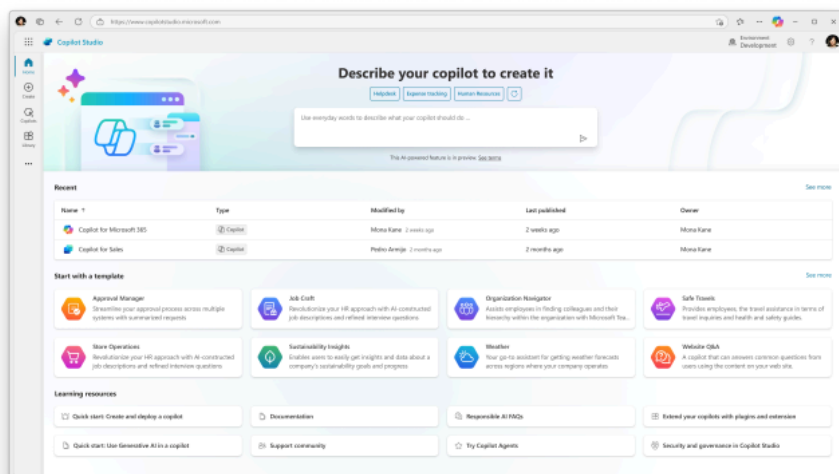


IMAGE CREDITS: MICROSOFT

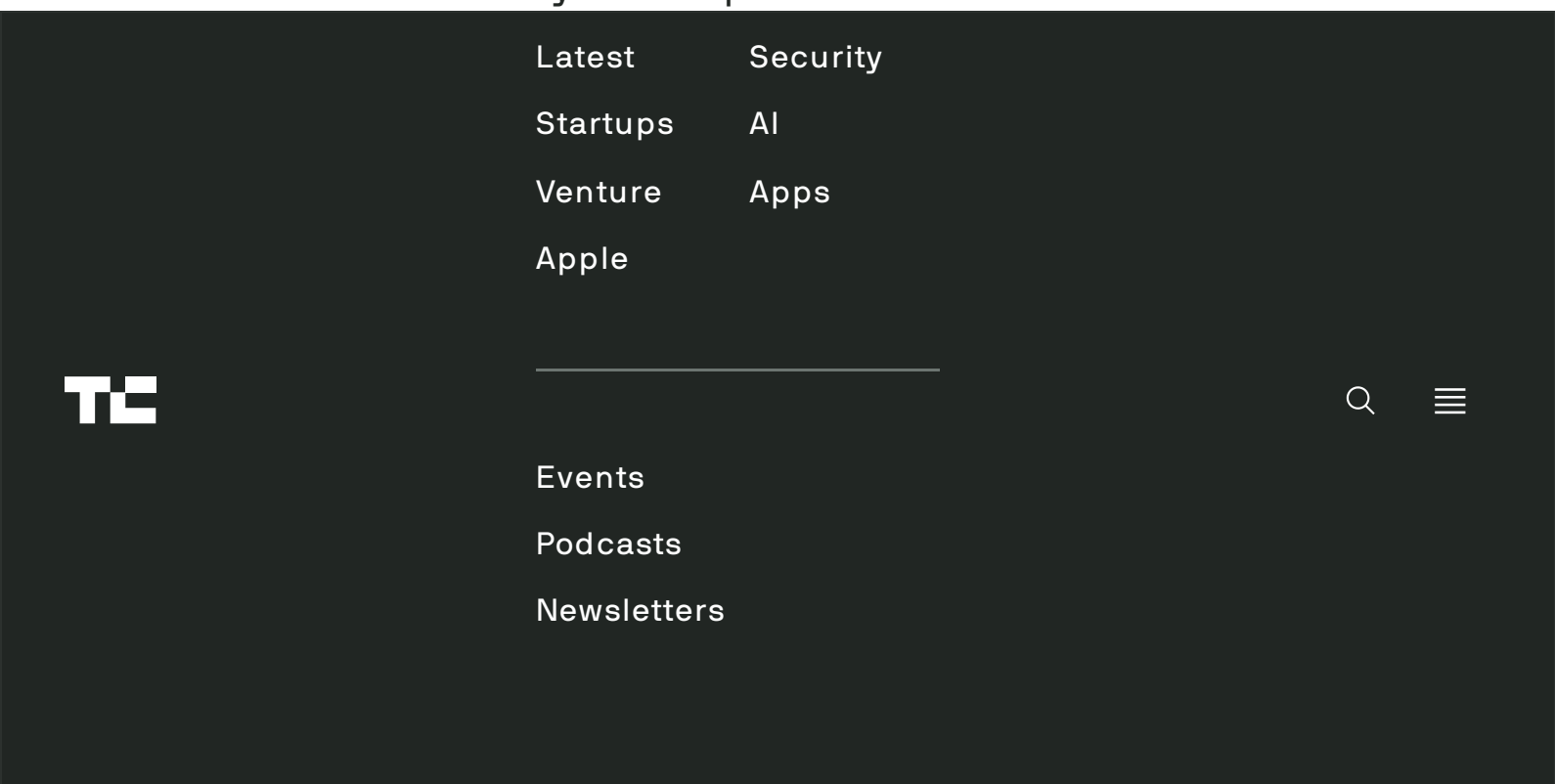
Copilot Studio is also where customers can craft what Microsoft calls **Copilot agents**. These AI bots

— which can be “@ mentioned” in Outlook and Teams — leverage memory and knowledge of context to navigate different business workflows, learning from user feedback and asking for help when they encounter situations they don’t know how to handle.

Copilot agents range in capability from simple, prompt-and-response agents to more sophisticated bots — think bots that can monitor email inboxes and automate data entry. Microsoft provides a number of pre-built ones, including the Visual creator agent that generates images, designs, and soon videos.

What is GitHub Copilot?

Not to be confused with the many other Copilots in



[GitHub Copilot can also translate code](#) into natural language descriptions, and [Copilot Extensions](#) allow developers to extend Copilot with third-party skills. In February, [GitHub announced a ton of new updates](#) for Copilot. Among them: Vision for Copilot, which allows people to attach a screenshot, photo,

or diagram to a chat, and Copilot will generate the interface, code, and alt text to bring it to life.

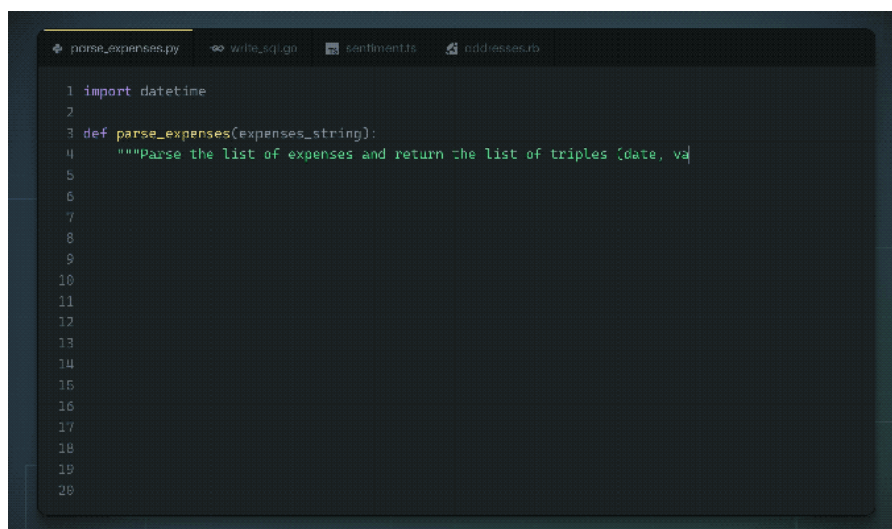


IMAGE CREDITS:GITHUB

GitHub Copilot is available for free for students and for “verified” open source contributors and educators. For individuals, it’s \$10 per month. For [business](#) customers, it’s \$19 per month per user. And for [enterprises](#), it’s \$39 per user per month.

Individual, business and enterprise subscribers get [Copilot Chat](#) along with GitHub Copilot, a chatbot-like flow that’s aware of the entire context of the code they’re working on and can answer questions about that code. In addition to answering coding queries, Chat can help developers fix errors and bugs and address security issues through code analysis.

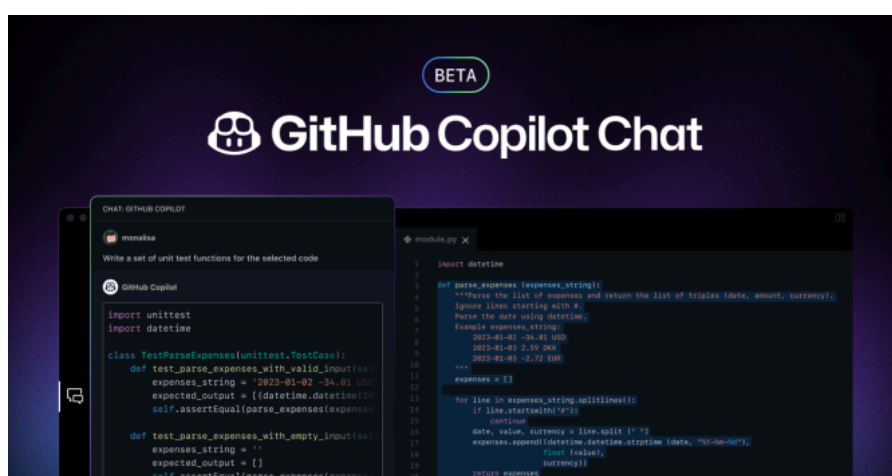


IMAGE CREDITS:GITHUB

The enterprise and business GitHub Copilot plans include license management, [IP indemnity](#), organization-wide policy management, and added privacy features. Enterprise customers can [customize for their codebases](#) and knowledge bases and fine-tune the underlying models, as well as access Copilot through the Microsoft Copilot on the web and use Copilot Chat on GitHub.com.

In April, GitHub launched [Copilot Workspace](#), a sort of take on AI-powered software engineering. Workspace provides a dev environment that taps AI-powered agents to help brainstorm, plan, build, test and run code in natural language.

Issues with Copilot

Owing to the complex and fraught nature of today's generative AI tech, Microsoft's Copilots have their issues.

The models occasionally [make mistakes when summarizing](#) or answering questions because of their tendency to [hallucinate](#), including while summarizing meetings. The Wall Street Journal cited an instance where, for one early adopter using Copilot for Teams meetings, [Copilot invented attendees](#) and implied that calls were about subjects that were never actually discussed.

As for GitHub Copilot, GitHub itself warns that it can produce [insecure coding patterns](#), bugs, and references to outdated APIs, or idioms reflecting the imperfect code in its training data. The code Copilot suggests might not always compile or run — or even make sense.

[Security and privacy concerns](#) loom large over Copilot, as well. But perhaps the elephant in the room is the unresolved fair-use question.

Like most generative AI models, the models powering Microsoft's Copilots were trained on public data, some of which is copyrighted or under a restrictive license. Microsoft — among others — argues that the [fair-use](#) doctrine shields it from copyright claims. But that hasn't stopped data owners from [filing class action lawsuits against the company](#), GitHub, OpenAI, and many more over what owners allege are clear licensing and IP violations.

Microsoft [offers policies](#) to protect certain customers from courtroom battles arising from fair use challenges — at least in narrow circumstances. That doesn't resolve the ethical quandary of training models on data without permission, however, which may be more than some customers can swallow.

This story originally published in August 2024 and will be updated periodically with new information.

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch's AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital...

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CURSOR

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Cursor snaps up enterprise startup Koala in challenge to GitHub Copilot

Maxwell Zeff — 12:56 PM PDT · July 18, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: CURSOR

The startup behind the viral AI coding app [Cursor](#) is snapping up top talent from AI enterprise startups in a bid to bolster its competition with Microsoft's GitHub Copilot and win over businesses looking to supercharge their employees with AI coding tools.

In one recent case, Cursor maker Anysphere struck a deal to acquire the AI-powered customer relationship management (CRM) startup Koala, two sources familiar with the matter told TechCrunch.

As part of the deal, Cursor will bring on several of Koala's top engineers to build out a dedicated enterprise-readiness team. However, the entire

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Koala team will not be joining Anysphere, and Cursor does not plan to integrate the startup's core CRM product, a source told TechCrunch.

Koala plans to shut down in September, the company said in a [blog post](#) published on Friday. The announcement comes just five months after Koala raised a [\\$15 million Series A](#) led by CRV, with participation from HubSpot Ventures, Recall Capital, and Afore. Koala was nearly four years old; had [roughly 30 employees](#), according to LinkedIn; and had worked with clients such as Vercel, Statsig, and Retool.

Sources in this story requested anonymity to speak with TechCrunch about private matters. Koala and its founders did not respond to TechCrunch's request for comment. Cursor declined to comment.

The Koala deal paints a picture of the two types of AI startups we're seeing in 2025. There's Cursor, a juggernaut of an AI tool that is growing so fast [it's starting to encroach on the AI space's largest players](#), including Microsoft and Anthropic. At the same time, there's a growing number of startups like Koala: B2B AI startups that seemed promising — with a co-founder from Meta and advisers like Jack Altman — but have quickly run out of steam.

Cursor is capitalizing on this disparity, leveraging middling AI startups as a means to build out its own enterprise offerings. Anysphere also recently [hired the CEO of cybersecurity startup ResourceCy, Travis McPeak](#), to lead the company's security teams, according to The Information.

Sarah Perez - 12 hours ago

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Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

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These deals look a lot like Big Tech's reverse acquisitions, such as [Meta's recent deal to hire Scale AI's leaders](#). Much like in Meta and Scale's deal, Cursor can now move quickly to build out new business segments while leaving questionable businesses behind.

Cursor hopes that Koala and Resourceely's talent will help it evolve from a personal developer tool that engineers quietly use at work and become an enterprise-wide platform that companies pay large contracts to access. Most enterprises today that offer employees an AI tool choose Microsoft's GitHub Copilot, which works as an AI-powered extension to existing integrated development environments (IDEs) such as VS Code or JetBrains.

Cursor, which is a stand-alone AI-powered IDE, needs to beat out GitHub Copilot to strike deals in many cases, and it often does in head-to-head tests. Still, Microsoft has the upper hand in the enterprise thanks to its long-standing relationships with legacy companies, as well as its large sales, security, and support teams.

In the last year, Cursor has decisively built out its go-to-market and sales team — which now contains dozens of employees. Several Cursor

employees now spend their days visiting the offices of Fortune 500 companies and showing them how they can integrate Cursor's AI tools into their business, according to a person familiar with the matter.

Cursor's enterprise push seems to be gaining traction. AnySphere said it [reached \\$500 million in ARR in June](#) and now works with more than half of the Fortune 500, including Nvidia, Uber, and Adobe. A source familiar with the matter says that revenue has since grown, and an increasingly large share of that growth comes from enterprise deals.

But as Cursor competes with Microsoft, it also needs to fend off a growing field of threats.

The most pressing one is Anthropic, a crucial partner to AnySphere, whose [Claude Code product has grown rapidly in recent months](#). Cursor relies heavily on Anthropic's AI models to power its own coding products. (As one of its biggest customers, Cursor is also vital to Anthropic.)

At the same time, Google just [scooped up the leadership team of Windsurf](#), a major competitor to Cursor in the AI-powered IDE space. Cognition, the maker of the AI coding agent Devin, [acquired the rest of Windsurf's team](#), potentially offering a significant lift to both businesses.

It's worth noting that all of these are different types of AI tools, but employers tend to view the products similarly: as AI tools that can improve the productivity of software engineers. These employers might have the right idea. After all, Anthropic, Microsoft, Cursor, and Cognition are all [developing AI coding agents that aim to automate workflows completely](#), which may be where the AI coding space converges.

You might ask, why is everyone competing with everyone else to build AI coding products? Coding tools have become one of the first AI products to find “product market fit” — the elusive goal that makes the ears of venture capitalists perk up. AI coding products are being used daily by millions of software engineers, and they have started to generate real revenue.

The race isn’t just about building the best AI coding tool anymore, though. It’s about who can scale their enterprise operations the fastest while the market is still up for grabs. With the likes of Microsoft, Google, and Anthropic all moving fast, Cursor’s acquisition strategy may determine whether it joins their ranks or becomes another startup that couldn’t scale fast enough.

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Maxwell Zeff

Senior AI Reporter |

Maxwell Zeff is a senior reporter at TechCrunch specializing in AI. Previously with Gizmodo, Bloomberg,...

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